

**ZAMBIA**

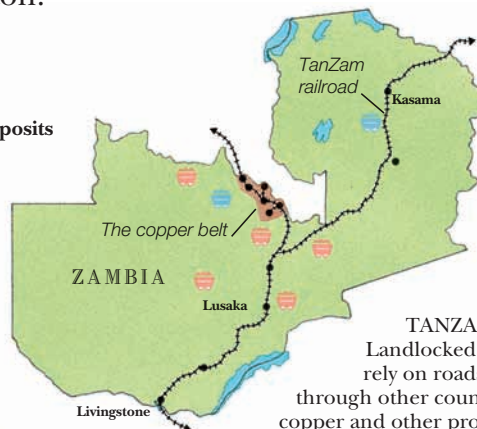
Capital city: Lusaka
Area: 290,584 sq miles (752,614 sq km)
Population: 10,800,000
Official languages: English
Major religions: Christian 63%, traditional beliefs 36%, other 1%
Government: Multiparty democracy
Currency: Zambian kwacha
Adult literacy rate: 80%
Life expectancy: 37 years
People per doctor: 10,000
Televisions: 137 per 1,000 people

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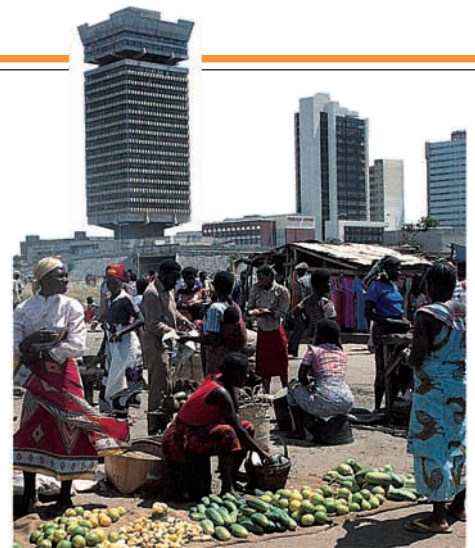
ZAMBIA OCCUPIES A BROAD plateau scattered with mountains and deep valleys. After independence from Britain in 1963, political violence based on tribal differences rocked the country until 1972, when President Kenneth Kaunda declared a one-party state. In 1991, Kaunda was defeated in the first democratic election in 19 years. Today, the country is less affected by ethnic conflict than many African states, even though there are 14 main tribal groups. Zambia is the world's largest producer of copper, and also exports seasonal vegetables, flowers, and cotton.

Mineral deposits in Zambia

- Copper
- Cobalt

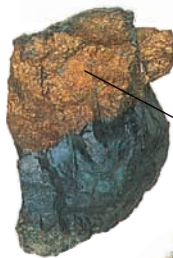
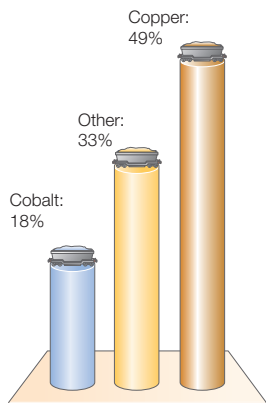


TANZAM RAILROAD
Landlocked Zambia has to rely on roads and railroads through other countries to export copper and other products to ports, so good relations with its neighbors are important. Until the 1960s, most goods went through Rhodesia (now Zimbabwe), but relations between the two countries broke down. Today, the main trade route is the TanZam railroad through Tanzania.



CITIES

A chain of shantytowns lies along the railroad linking Zambia's copper belt with the capital, Lusaka. The makeshift shacks have no water, power, or drains, and disease is widespread. Most people here have jobs in the copper industry. In fact, 40 percent of Zambians live in the towns, making it the most urbanized country in the region. Many Zambian families have been city dwellers for three or four generations, which is rare in Africa.

Zambia's exports


Copper ore

COPPER MINING

Seams of copper run through an area more than 200 miles (320 km) long and 30 miles (50 km) wide in central Zambia called the copper belt. First developed commercially in the 1930s, copper mining has funded much of Zambia's development. Copper accounts for 50 percent of the country's exports, and if the world price of copper were to fall, Zambia's economy could be wrecked. To add to this problem, the copper reserves are beginning to run out.



ZAMBEZI RIVER

Forming Zambia's southern border, the Zambezi River is one of the country's main tourist attractions. Visitors can go white-water rafting on the river, take a wildlife safari in one of the area's game parks, and visit the magnificent Victoria Falls. A huge dam at Kariba provides power in the form of hydroelectricity for Zambia's copper belt and for neighboring Zimbabwe. Lake Kariba, the artificial lake formed by the dam, is a popular fishing destination for tourists.



The TanZam railroad links Zambia to the port of Dar es Salaam in neighboring Tanzania.



FISH EAGLE
National parks, set up to protect wildlife, take up more than one-third of the country's area. The fish eagle is Zambia's national symbol, and appears on the country's flag. It is common around open stretches of water, where it swoops down to snatch fish from the surface and rises up with a fish in its talons.

Find out more

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